

IELTS Writing Task 1: Maps & Process Pack

Book 9 · Handle diagrams and maps without panic

Stratum IELTS · stratumielts.com

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Part of the Stratum IELTS Writing Guide Series

Who this book is for

Charts feel manageable.

Then the exam gives a **process diagram** or **before/after map** — and you freeze.

This pack focuses only on those two Task 1 types (Academic).

For line/bar/pie/table language, use **Book 2: Task 1 Charts Pack**.

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1. Shared Task 1 rules

- At least **150 words**, about **20 minutes**
- Paraphrase the question
- Include a clear **overview**
- Select key features; do not invent reasons
- No personal opinion

20-minute plan

Time	Action
0–3	Understand stages/locations + choose overview points
3–17	Write intro, overview, 2 detail paragraphs

17–20

Check tense, sequence, spelling

2. Process diagrams

What to notice

- Where the process starts and ends
- Number of main stages
- Materials in → product out
- Cycles (if anything returns)

Structure

1. **Intro** — paraphrase what the diagram shows
2. **Overview** — total stages + start/end (sometimes split into two phases)
3. **Details A** — first half of stages
4. **Details B** — remaining stages

Overview formula

Overall, the process consists of [n] stages, beginning with [start] and ending with [end].

Sequence language

first / to begin with / next / after that / following this / subsequently / finally
After being cleaned... / *Once the pulp is formed...*

Voice tip

Passive is common and natural here: *is collected, is heated, is transported.*

3. Maps (change over time)

What to notice

- Biggest changes (added / removed / converted)
- Unchanged areas
- Location language (north, south, adjacent to, opposite)

Structure

1. **Intro** — maps of X in year A and year B
2. **Overview** — 2–3 major changes
3. **Details A** — one zone / one set of changes

4. **Details B** — remaining zone / remaining changes

Overview formula

Overall, the area became more [residential/commercial], with the most noticeable changes in [zone].

Change verbs

was built / was removed / was replaced by / was converted into / was expanded / was relocated

Location phrases

to the north of / in the south-west / between A and B / beside / opposite / along the road

Use past tense for completed past changes (*in 2000... by 2020...*).

4. Language banks

Process

- The diagram illustrates the process of...
- The cycle begins with...
- In the subsequent stage...
- The final product is...

Maps

- The maps compare the layout of... in ... and ...
- A major development was...
- The park was replaced by...
- Little change occurred in...

Avoid

- listing every tiny label without grouping
- explaining *why* the town changed (unless asked)
- present tense for finished past map years

5. Model reports (original)

A) Process — recycled paper (imagined 7-stage flow)

The diagram illustrates how recycled paper is produced from used paper.

Overall, the process contains seven main stages, beginning with collection and sorting and ending with finished paper ready for reuse.

In the first stages, used paper is collected from homes and offices and then sorted so that unwanted materials such as plastic are removed. The cleaned paper is shredded into small pieces and mixed with water and chemicals to form pulp.

After this, the pulp is cleaned to remove ink and dirt, spread onto a mesh, and rolled into thin sheets. Finally, the sheets are dried and cut, producing recycled paper that can re-enter use.

B) Map — town centre 2000 vs 2020 (imagined changes)

The maps show the layout of a town centre in 2000 and 2020.

Overall, the centre became more commercial and transport-focused. The most noticeable changes were the replacement of the park with a shopping centre and the addition of a bus station in the north.

In 2000, a park occupied the central area, with small shops along the south road and houses in the east. By 2020, the park had been converted into a large shopping centre, while several houses in the east were replaced by apartments.

In the north, a new bus station was built beside the main road, improving public transport access. The library in the west remained in the same location, showing that not every facility was redesigned.

6. Practice drills

1. Draw a 6-stage process (coffee / plastic recycling / water treatment) and write a 150-word report in 20 minutes.
2. Sketch two mini-maps of a school campus (old/new) and write an overview in 2 sentences only.
3. Rewrite a chart-style essay habit: delete opinions; keep only description.
4. Underline all passive verbs in your process report — aim for clear sequence, not fancy vocabulary.

7. Next step on Stratum IELTS

Write one process + one map report, then check both at <https://stratumielts.com>

Focus feedback on: overview quality, sequence clarity, and tense control.

For standard charts, return to **Book 2**.

For vocabulary precision, use **Book 3**.

About this booklet

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